



Designing and Building a Website

An attractive, user-friendly website gives your business the edge on its competitors. Take time to examine all your possible options and choose carefully to ensure the site will meet your present and future needs.

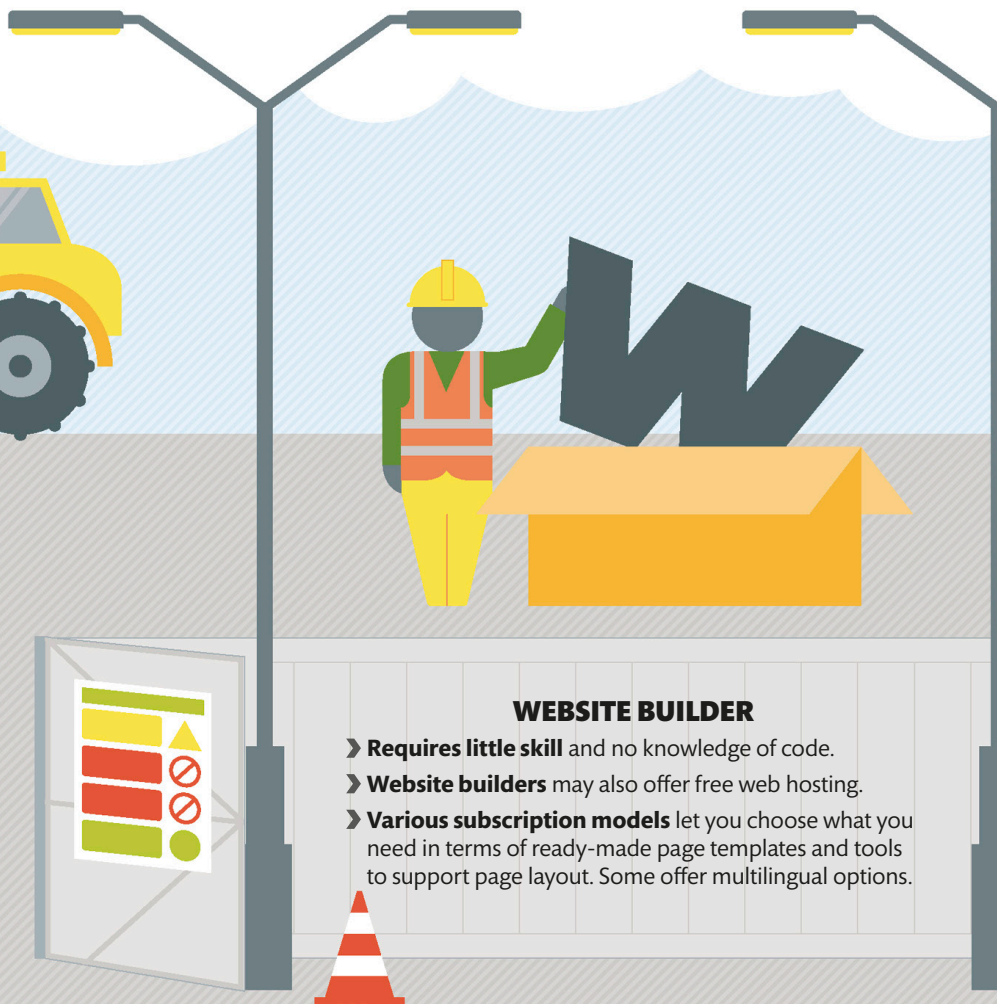
Build for usability

Whether its purpose is to provide information about your company or to sell goods or services, your website must be accessible and easy to use. To get started, you will need a web-hosting service (see pp.114–115). Some website builders offer combined web hosting and templates, which is an attractive option, but may not

meet all your needs. Shared web hosting, for example, means sharing hardware with multiple other users, which can slow down your website's operating time, and some website builders are not “search engine optimization” (SEO) friendly (see p.118–119), making it harder for users to access your content. A content management system (CMS)

Ways to build a website

Website building can be quite straightforward, requiring no knowledge of computer code. Website builders enable you to simply drop your content into templates. Content management systems require a little more know-how but offer more control over your site's structure. Building your own site, or hiring someone to do it for you, offers the greatest creative freedom but requires technical skill.



WEBSITE BUILDER

- **Requires little skill** and no knowledge of code.
- **Website builders** may also offer free web hosting.
- **Various subscription models** let you choose what you need in terms of ready-made page templates and tools to support page layout. Some offer multilingual options.